

21. What is the factor of Tropical cyclone in the month of May?

- (a) Cyclone of Bay of Bengal
- (b) Western disturbance
- (c) Local temperature variation
- (d) North eastern winds.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Preconditions for the emergence of a tropical cyclone are-

- (i) Large and continuous supply of warm and moist air that can release enormous latent heat.
- (ii) Enormous coriolis force that can prevent the filling of low pressure at the centre.
- (iii) Unstable conditions throughout the troposphere that creates local disturbances around which a cyclone develops.
- (iv) Absence of a strong vertical wind wedge.

The most important factor for the tropical cyclone in the month of May is local temperature variation. The enhanced but uneven temperature rise over the coastal region generates suction for the cyclone and thus cyclone deflects from its natural path towards the warmer region to gather this extra entropy. It helps in the enlarging the diameter and inland reach of the cyclone thereby intensifying the severity of cyclone and the regional vulnerability. Local temperature variation is fuel for the tropical cyclones in their genesis and intensification.

22. What is 'Ockhi' which has been in the news recently ?

- (a) Cyclonic storm that hit India's coast in November 2017
- (b) The film that won the 'Golden Peacock' Award in the International Film Festival held in Goa in November 2017
- (c) The venue in Bangladesh where Asian Archery Championship was held in November 2017
- (d) The nearest place in Doklam area where Chinese army is stationed

U.P.S.C. (GIC) 2017

Ans. (a)

'Ockhi' is a cyclonic storm that hit India's coast in November 2017. This cyclone was categorized as an 'extremely severe cyclonic storm.'

23. From the following, which cyclone struck the western coast of India in the year 2021?

- (a) Amphan
- (b) Tauktae
- (c) Michaung
- (d) Fani

M.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

In 2021, the cyclone that hit the Western Coast was Tauktae. It was an extremely severe cyclonic storm that caused heavy damage in Gujarat, Maharashtra and other coastal areas. Tauktae formed in the Arabian Sea from May 14 to 19, 2021 and made landfall on the coast.

Amphan- This cyclone occurred in May 2020 and primarily affected the coastal areas of West Bengal, Odisha and Bangladesh.

Michaung- This cyclone formed in the Bay of Bengal in December 2023 and mainly affected the coastal areas of Andhra Pradesh.

Fani- This cyclone occurred in 2019 and affected Odisha and some parts of eastern India.

24. Which of these cyclones affected coastal region of Tamil Nadu during November-December, 2024?

- (a) Asna
- (b) Dana
- (c) Biparjoy
- (d) Fengal

M.P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

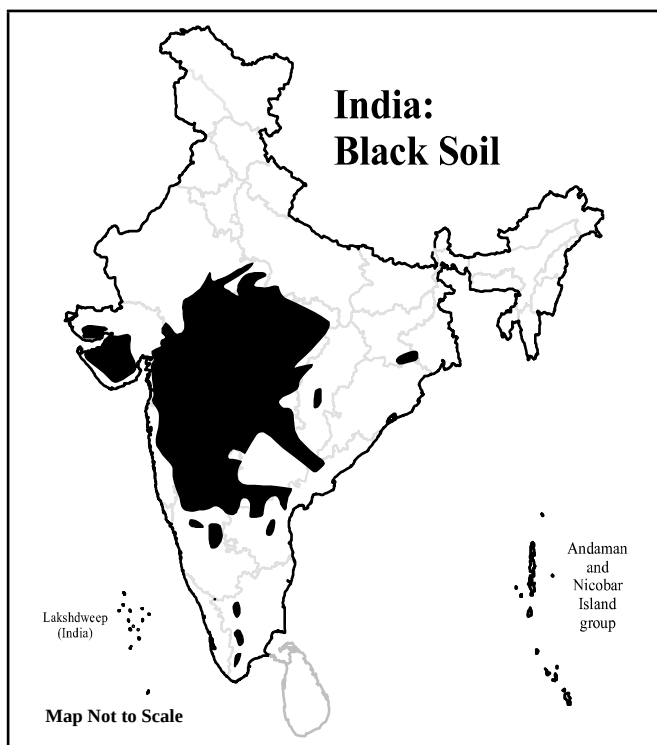
Ans. (d)

At the end of November and the beginning of December 2024, cyclone Fengal formed in the southwestern Bay of Bengal and moved west and west-southwest, crossing the coastal regions of northern Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, affecting their coastal areas.

Soils

I. Black Soil

*The Black soil is also known as the '**Regur Soil**', or the '**Black Cotton Soil**', '**Tropical Black Earth**' or the '**Tropical Chernozem**'. *These soils are formed by the weathering and erosional work of **Basalt Lava**. *These soils cover most of the Deccan trap especially in the states of Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Telangana. Geographically, it spreads over 5.46 Lakh sq km in different Indian states. *The Black soils are very suitable for cultivation of **cotton**. These soils are rich in **Lime, Iron, Magnesium carbonate, Alumina, Potash and Calcium**. They also contain Potash but they lack in **Phosphorus, Nitrogen and Organic Matter**.



*The black soils are generally clayey, deep, and impermeable. They swell and become sticky when wet and **shrink** when dried. During the dry season, these soils develop wide cracks. Thus, there occurs a kind of **self ploughing**. Because of this characteristic of slow absorption and loss of moisture, the black soil retains the moisture for a long time.

*The colour of Black Cotton soil ranges from **deep black, similar to** the colour of Chestnut. *According to 'Krebs', the Black soil is a mature soil in which special relief and climate play an important role.

1. Which of the following soils of India has been formed due to weathering of basaltic lava?

(a) Alluvial Soils (b) Laterite Soils
(c) Red Soils (d) Regur Soils

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2015

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Regur Soils are formed by the weathering and erosional work of Basaltic lava. The Regur soil is also known as Black Soil, Black Cotton Soil or the Tropical Black Earth or Tropical Chernozem.

2. The black cotton soil of India has been formed due to the weathering of :

(a) brown forest soil (b) fissure volcanic rock
(c) granite and schist (d) shale and limestone

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Regur soil or Black soil has been formed due to weathering of basaltic lava. This type of soil is typical of Deccan trap (Basalt) region which spreads over north-west Deccan plateau and is made up of lava flow. It is ideal for growing cotton. It covers the plateau of Maharashtra, Saurashtra, Malwa, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and extends to the Godavari and Krishna valleys.

3. Regur is the name of –

(a) Red soil (b) Alluvial soil
(c) Black soil (d) Lateritic soil

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1998

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

The black soil is also called 'Regur' (from the Telugu word Reguda), cotton soils and tropical Chernozem, etc. This soil is mainly found in Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, parts of Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, and Telangana. Geographically, Black soil is spread over 5.46 lakh sq. km.

4. Regur soil is most widespread in –

(a) Maharashtra (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Jharkhand

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Black cotton soil is also known by which of the following?

(a) Banger (b) Khadar
(c) Bhur (d) Regur

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

Black soil is also known as Regur soil. It is a mature soil and has high water retention capacity. Self-ploughing is a characteristic of black soil as it develops wide cracks when dried.

6. Assertion (A) : The Regur soils of the Deccan Trap are black in colour.

Reason (R) : They are rich in Humus.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

The black soil of the Deccan Trap is also known as Regur or Reguda. The black soil is very suitable for cotton cultivation. It lacks in phosphorus, nitrogen and organic matter (humus). The black soil is rich in Alumina, Iron, Lime, Magnesium carbonates and potash. Hence, statement (A) is true but (R) is false.

7. Which of the following soils of India is most suitable for cotton cultivation?

- (a) Regur soil (b) Laterite soil
(c) Alluvial soil (d) Red soil

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. For which cultivation are Karewas are famous?

- (a) Banana
(b) Saffron
(c) Mango
(d) Grapes
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (b)

Karewas are the thick deposits of glacial clay and other materials embedded with moraines. The Kashmir Himalayas are famous for Karewa formations, which are useful for the cultivation of Zafran (a local variety of saffron).

9. Assertion (A) : Black soils are suitable for cotton cultivation.

Reason (R) : They are rich in humus.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

'Black Soil' or 'Regur Soil' or 'Black Cotton Soil' is generally clayey, deep and impermeable. It swells and becomes sticky when wet, and shrinks when dried. So, during the dry season, this soil develops wide cracks. Thus, there occurs a kind of 'Self-ploughing'. Because of this characteristic, black soil retains moisture for a very long time, which helps the crops, especially the rainfed ones, to sustain even during the dry season. Due to these characteristics, black soils are suitable for cotton cultivation. This soil lacks Phosphorus, Nitrogen, and Humus.

10. Assertion (A) : Black soils are suitable for cotton cultivation.

Reason (R) : They are rich in nitrogen and organic matter.

In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Which of the following is known as "self-ploughed" soil in the country?

- (a) Alluvial soil (b) Lateritic soil
(c) Black cotton soils (d) Desert soils

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. Which soil is best suited for cotton cultivation?

- (a) Black (b) Red
(c) Alluvial (d) Laterite

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

13. Lava soils are found in:

- (a) Chhattisgarh plains (b) Trans Saryu plains
(c) Malwa plateau (d) Shillong Plateau

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)